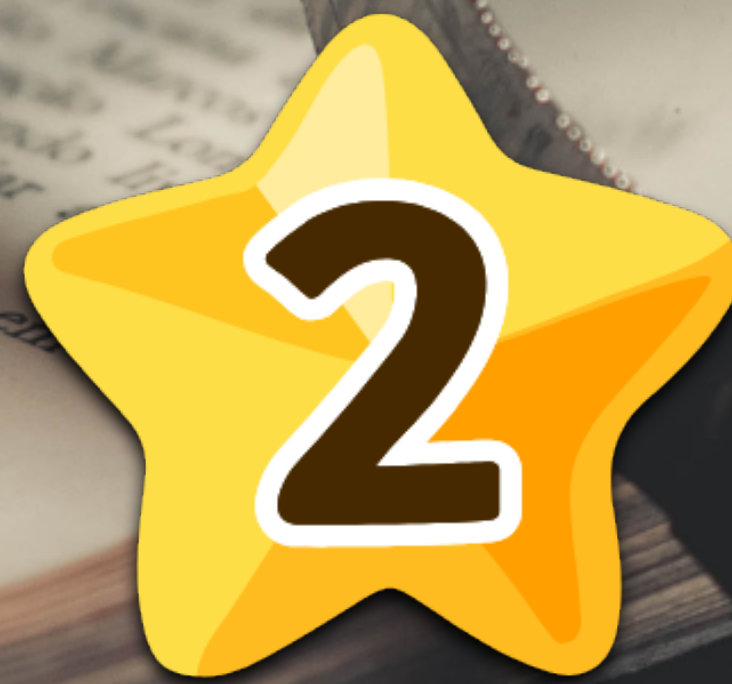
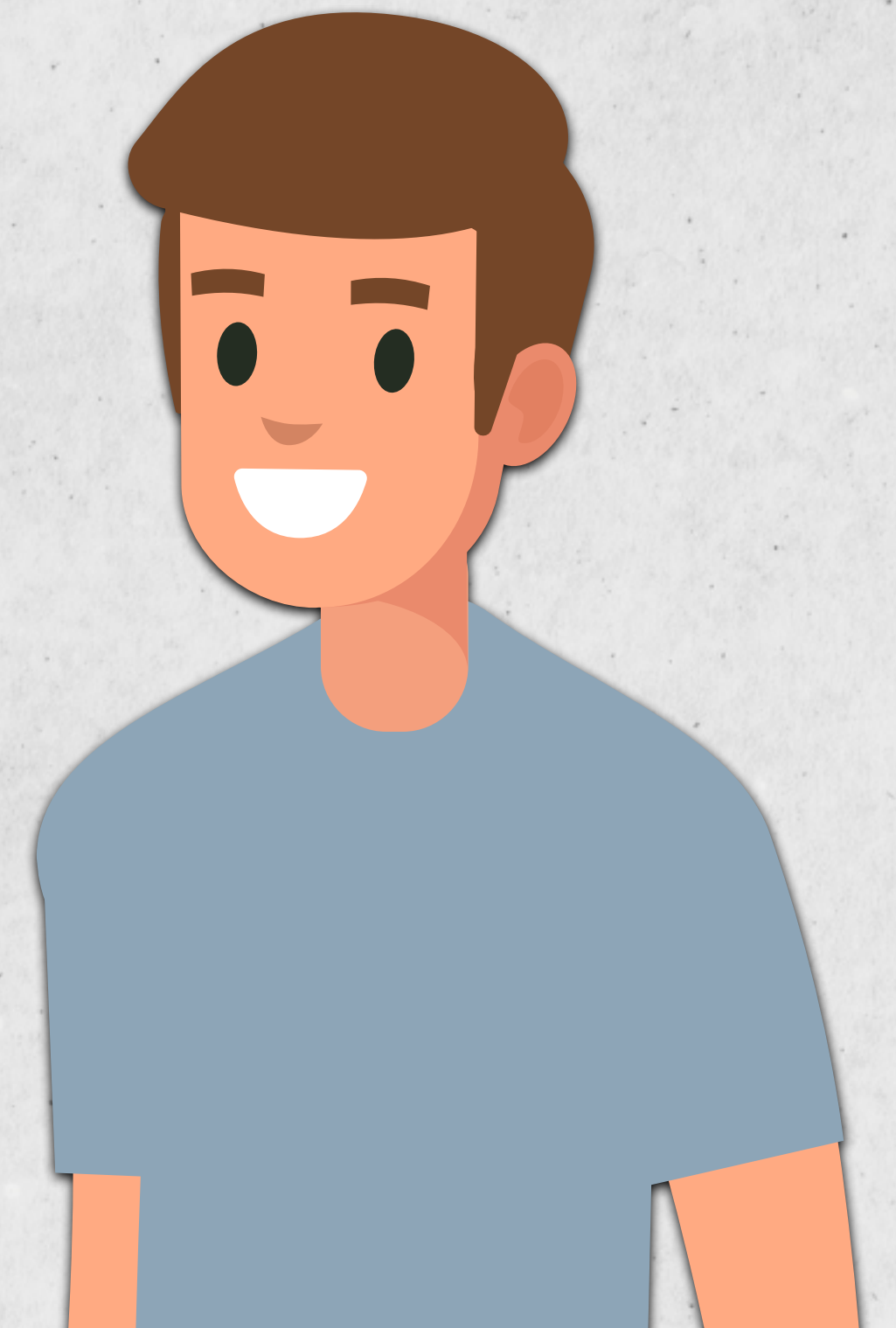




EVALUATING NUTRITION INFORMATION

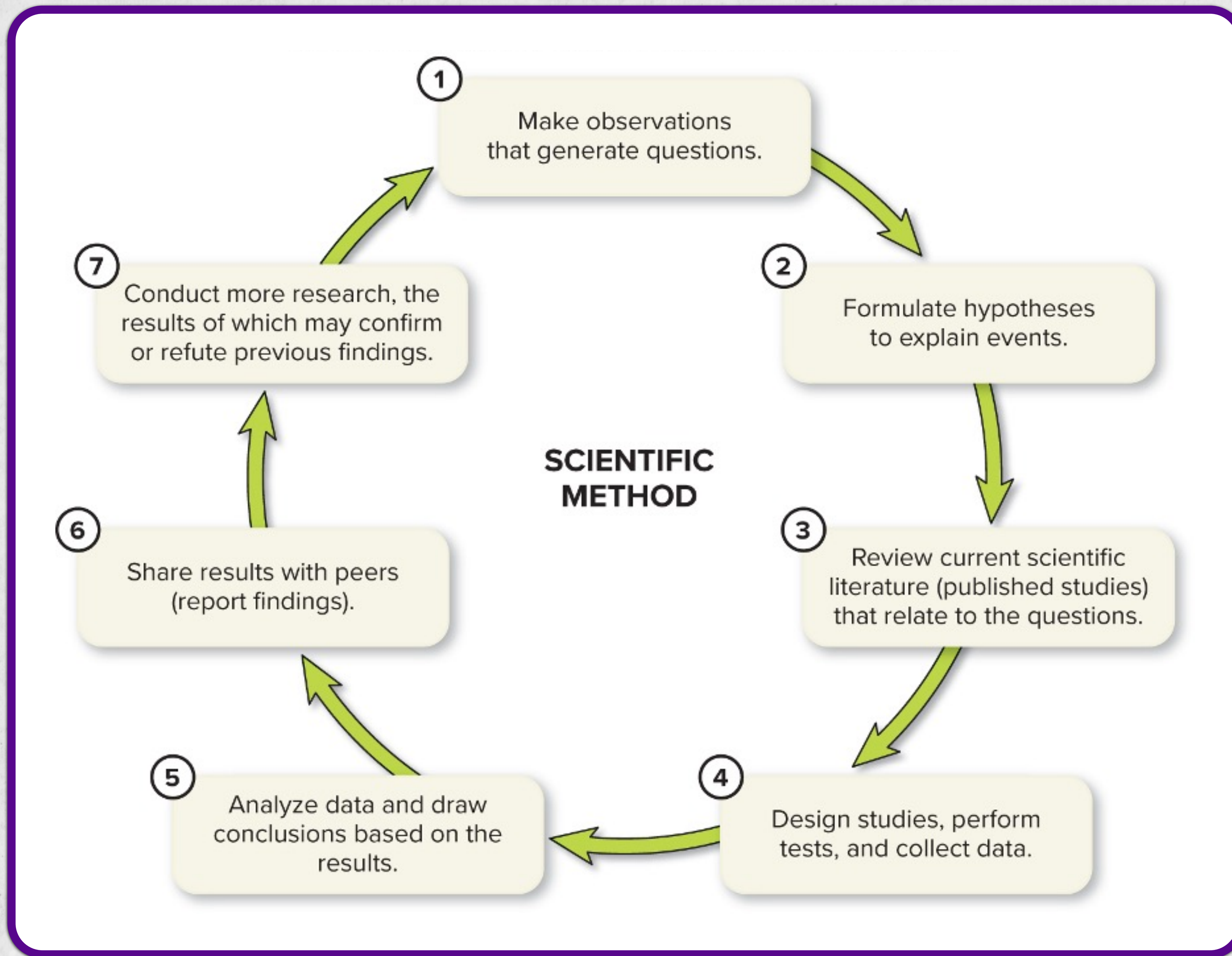
LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- 01 Review the importance of treating nutrition as a science
- 02 Learn how to become a more careful and critical consumer of nutrition information



NUTRITION AS A SCIENCE

- **Nutrition recommendations are based on the results of scientific research**
 - ➡ A hypothesis is developed through questions about the world
 - ➡ An experiment is conducted to test the hypothesis
- **Each experiment contributes to a body of evidence on a given subject**
 - ➡ Every new experiment has the opportunity to impact knowledge of that subject
 - ➡ Some experiments are more impactful than others





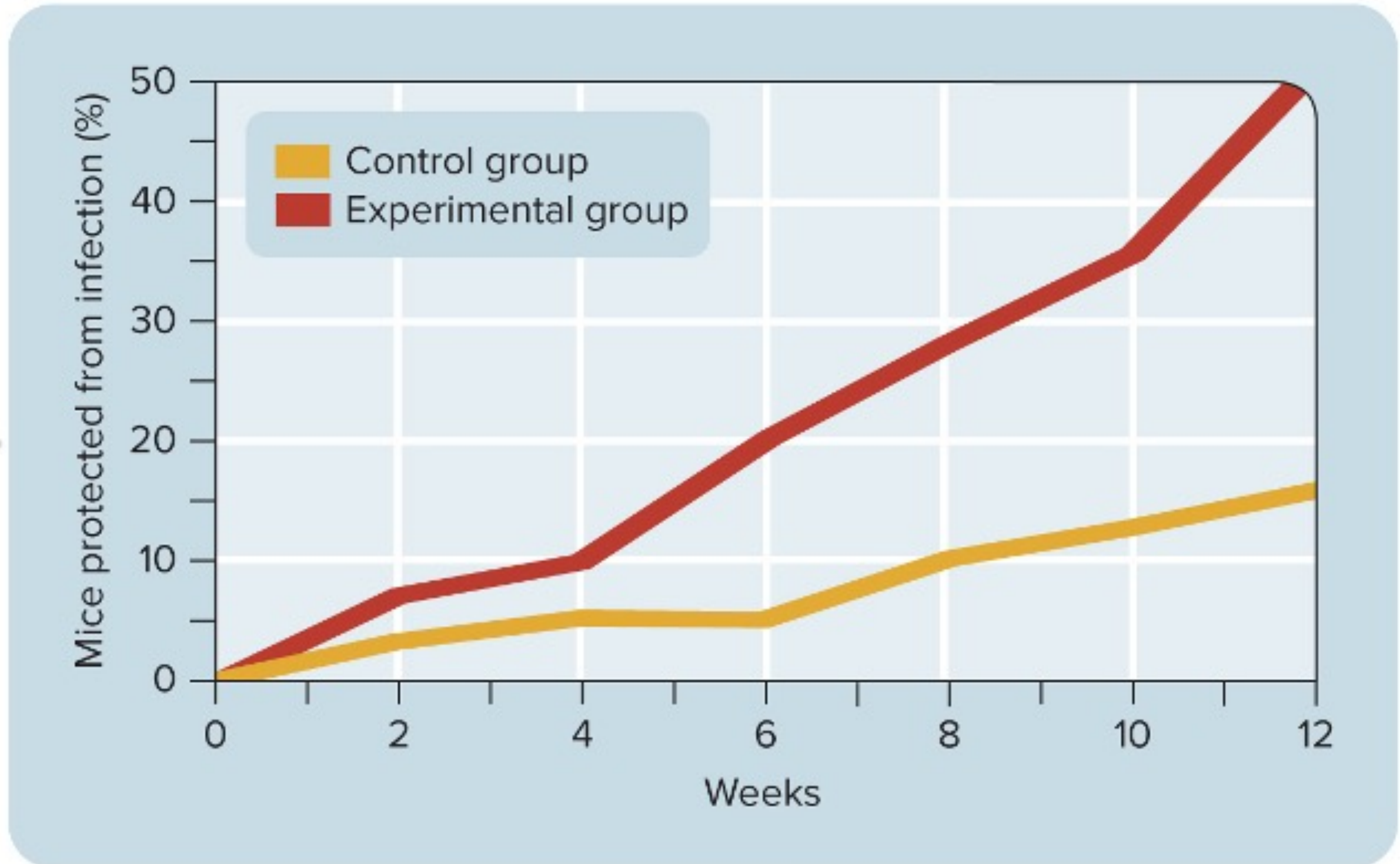
Control group
(50 mice) after 12 weeks



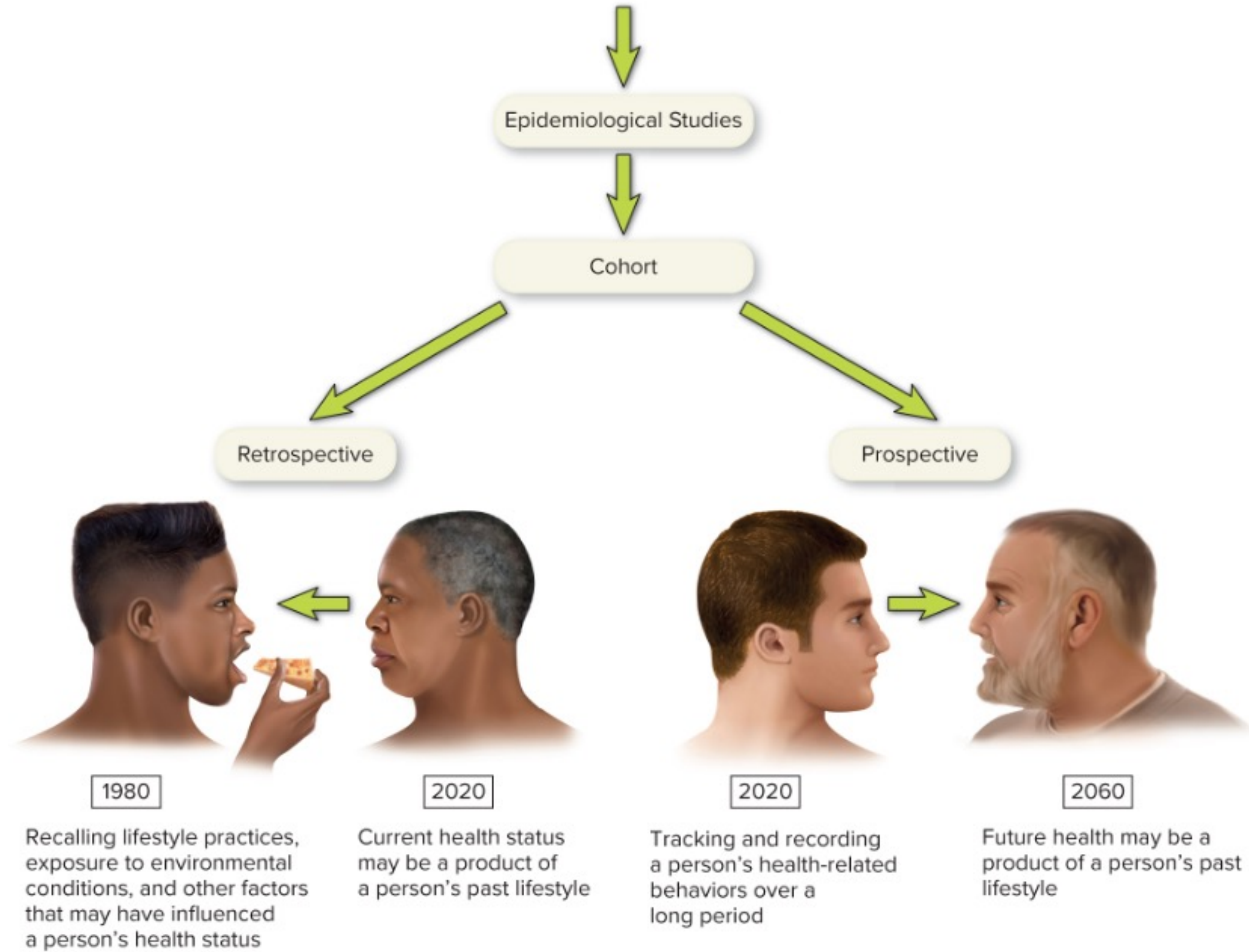
Health
data



Experimental group
(50 mice) after 12 weeks



OBSERVATIONAL STUDIES



ANECDOTES

- **Personal reports concerning the effectiveness of a treatment**
 - ➡ Example: “My grandmother drank 2 sodas/day and lived to be 105 years old”
- **Considered to be the lowest form of evidence for an intervention**
 - ➡ Should not serve as the basis for nutrition recommendations

PSEUDOSCIENCE

- The presentation of misleading or false information as factual and scientific
 - ➔ Example: “Try a 30-day juice cleanse to detoxify your liver”
- There is often a tiny bit of truth that is misinterpreted or overextrapolated
 - ➔ Can be difficult for a layperson to identify



RESEARCH BIAS

- The field of nutrition science has been greatly impacted by industry funding
 - ➡ Food companies, drug companies, and related industries are heavily invested
- Some safeguards have been put in place to promote integrity
 - ➡ Reliable academic journals require authors to disclose their funding sources
 - ➡ Prior to publication, a paper should undergo peer review
 - ➡ Published papers can be subject to retraction

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

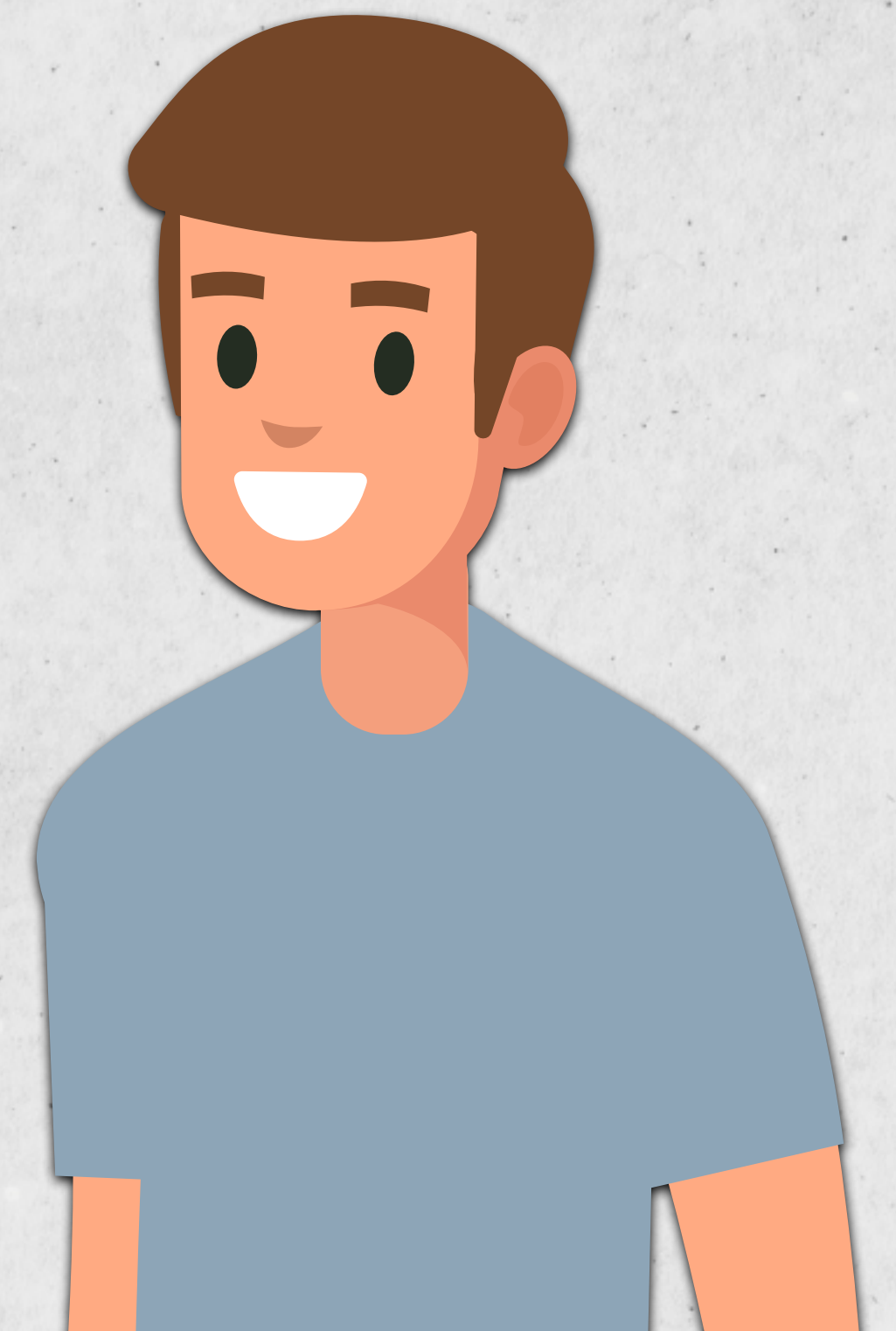


01

Review the importance of treating nutrition as a science

02

Learn how to become a more careful and critical consumer of nutrition information



ASK QUESTIONS

1. What motivates the authors, promoters, or sponsors of the information?

- Are they more interested in helping or selling a product?

2. Who is the source of the information?

- Do they have relevant and reliable credentials?

3. What is the source of information?

- Is it coming from a reliable peer-reviewed journal?
- What are reliable sources saying about the same topic?

LOOK FOR RED FLAGS

- 1. Promises of quick and easy remedies**
- 2. Claims that sound too good to be true**
- 3. Scare tactics**
- 4. Attacks of conventional scientists and experts**
- 5. Reliance on testimonials**
- 6. Promotion of benefits while overlooking risks**
- 7. Vague, meaningless, or scientific-sounding terms**
- 8. Vagues sources**
- 9. Pseudoscience**
- 10. Disclaimers**

USE THE INTERNET WISELY

- 1. Search for guidelines published by nationally-recognized organizations**
- 2. Become familiar with locating research studies on databases like PubMed**
- 3. Compare information using multiple sites and sources**
- 4. Be wary of websites that promote or sell products for profit**

LEARNING OBJECTIVES



01

Review the importance of treating nutrition as a science



02

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